

26CHCV01345 26CHCV01345

County: los-angeles

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Hearing date: 2026-08-10

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PLAINTIFFS' MOTION TO COMPEL FURTHER RESPONSES TO REQUESTS FOR PRODUCTION OF DOCUMENTS, SET ONE

Motion filed on July 7, 2026.

MOVING PARTY: Judith M. Brown-Williams and Alvin E. Williams

RESPONDING PARTY: State Farm General Insurance Company

NOTICE: OK

RELIEF REQUESTED: Plaintiffs seek further responses to Requests for Production of Documents, Set One, and production of additional claim-handling documents.

RULING: The hearing is continued to September 22, 2026, at 8:30 a.m.

BACKGROUND

On March 27, 2026, Judith M. Brown-Williams and Alvin E. Williams (Plaintiffs) filed a Complaint against State Farm General Insurance Company (State Farm), asserting causes of action for breach of contract and breach of the implied covenant of good faith and fair dealing. State Farm filed an Answer on May 6, 2026.

On May 9, 2026, Plaintiffs served Requests for Production of Documents, Set One. State Farm served verified responses and produced a 5,684-page, bookmarked and Bates-stamped PDF on June 9, 2026.

Plaintiffs filed this motion on July 7, 2026. On July 9, 2026, Plaintiffs filed a revised declaration and additional exhibits. State Farm filed an opposition and responsive separate statement on July 28, 2026. Plaintiffs filed a reply on August 4, 2026.

DISCUSSION

A motion to compel further responses must be accompanied by a declaration showing a reasonable and good-faith attempt, in person, by telephone, or by videoconference, to resolve each issue presented by the motion. (Code Civ. Proc., §§ 2016.040, subd. (a), 2031.310, subd. (b)(2).)

Before the motion was filed, the parties exchanged written meet-and-confer correspondence concerning the allegedly missing or illegible documents, the privilege log, and a proposed protective order. State Farm advised Plaintiffs that the privilege log and proposed protective order were forthcoming. No conference in person, by telephone, or by videoconference occurred before Plaintiffs filed the motion on July 7, 2026. The Court therefore finds that Plaintiffs filed the motion before completing the required meet-and-confer process. After the motion was filed, State Farm provided the privilege log and proposed protective order, the parties conferred in person, and State Farm provided a chart locating the documents Plaintiffs claimed were missing. (Harman Decl. ¶¶ 3-8, Exs. 1-6.)

The parties' submissions do not identify which requests remain disputed following these developments. The hearing is therefore continued to permit the parties to address the proposed protective order and identify any remaining issues.

CONCLUSION

Plaintiffs' motion is continued to September 22, 2026, at 8:30 a.m. Plaintiffs shall give notice.

No later than September 8, 2026, the parties shall meet and confer in person, by telephone, or by videoconference concerning the proposed protective order and any remaining issues raised by the motion.

If the parties agree upon a protective order, they shall lodge it no later than September 10, 2026. State Farm shall produce the materials it previously agreed to produce subject to the protective order within five court days after entry of the order.

No later than September 15, 2026, the parties shall file a joint status report, not exceeding five pages, identifying whether a protective order has been lodged or entered and each request for production that remains disputed. For each remaining request, the report shall state the relief Plaintiffs seek and State Farm's position. If the parties have not agreed upon a protective order, the report shall identify the terms that remain disputed.

No additional briefing may be filed without leave of court.